

15 papers · 6 threads · Your canon

With a canon, you instantly see which thread a paper extends — scaling, alignment, agents, reasoning, multimodality, efficiency. The canon is your mental map; this lesson builds it.

Which paper does your team refer to most often?

L3

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 LLM core
- 02 Alignment + reasoning
- 03 Agents + systems + architectures
- 04 Multimodal
- 05 6 research threads

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

Without a canon, every arXiv post looks new.

WHY

Real

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SCALE

Today

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SPEED

Now

A real reason this matters in industry today.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

15 landmark papers by name + year.

2

6 research threads.

3

Place any new paper in a thread.

4

Pick one paper to go deep on.

5

Your personal canon list.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

LLM core

Key concept of this lesson.

02

**Alignment +
reasoning**

Key concept of this lesson.

03

Agents + systems +...

Key concept of this lesson.

04

Multimodal

Key concept of this lesson.

01

PART 1 OF 4

LLM core

Key concept of this lesson.

LLM core

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

DEFINITION

LLM core

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Alignment + reasoning

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

Agents + systems + architectures

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

DEFINITION

Agents + systems + architectures

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Multimodal

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Build your 5-paper canon

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

1

2

3

4

Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

Which thread is your personal competitive advantage?

Q2

Which Indian author / org has shaped your thinking?

Q3

Which thread will dominate 2026?

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check

Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

MoE paper:

A

LoRA

B

Mixtral

C

DPO

D

SAM

MoE paper:



CORRECT ANSWER

Mixtral

WHY

Mistral's Mixtral = MoE

Alignment paper that replaces RLHF pipeline:

A CoT

B DPO

C SAM

D Sora

Alignment paper that replaces RLHF pipeline:



CORRECT ANSWER

DPO

WHY

DPO simplifies alignment

Post-Transformer candidate:

A

BERT

B

Mamba

C

GPT-2

D

Whisper

Post-Transformer candidate:



CORRECT ANSWER

Mamba

WHY

Mamba / SSMs

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How this lesson plays out in one real Indian context

THE SCENARIO

A team applies the lesson's main idea to a real workflow — and the results show up within a quarter.

THE TAKEAWAY

"Canon turns overwhelm into orientation."

WHAT TO NOTICE

- 1 LLM core
- 2 Alignment + reasoning
- 3 Agents + systems +...
- 4 Multimodal

Deep-dive pick

Pick 1 paper for Week-11 reproduction.

DELIVERABLES

- Pick from the 15.
- Write 5-sentence summary.
- Commit in cohort forum.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

Deliverable: Summary posted.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

"Canon turns overwhelm into orientation."

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 11

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

NEXT → Lesson 4 — Open-Source AI Communities.